RBT Mock Exam 2: Answer Key

The Stimulus Control Room

Score = number correct out of the 75 scored questions. Questions 2, 19, 20, 27, 30, 44, 50, 51, 59, 70 are unscored pilot questions (shown in gray). They don't count toward your score, but they're still worth reviewing. Use the quick key to check your answer sheet, then review the explanations for any question you missed.

Quick key

1. **D**	18. **C**	35. **B**	52. **D**	69. **C**
2. **B**	19. **C**	36. **B**	53. **B**	70. **A**
3. **A**	20. **A**	37. **C**	54. **B**	71. **C**
4. **D**	21. **A**	38. **C**	55. **A**	72. **A**
5. **C**	22. **A**	39. **D**	56. **A**	73. **B**
6. **B**	23. **C**	40. **B**	57. **D**	74. **D**
7. **A**	24. **D**	41. **D**	58. **D**	75. **B**
8. **B**	25. **B**	42. **A**	59. **C**	76. **D**
9. **A**	26. **B**	43. **A**	60. **B**	77. **D**
10. **B**	27. **D**	44. **C**	61. **C**	78. **B**
11. **B**	28. **B**	45. **C**	62. **A**	79. **D**
12. **C**	29. **A**	46. **A**	63. **D**	80. **D**
13. **D**	30. **D**	47. **A**	64. **C**	81. **B**
14. **D**	31. **B**	48. **A**	65. **C**	82. **D**
15. **C**	32. **B**	49. **C**	66. **A**	83. **A**
16. **A**	33. **C**	50. **D**	67. **C**	84. **C**
17. **D**	34. **A**	51. **C**	68. **A**	85. **B**

Questions by domain

Use this to see which content areas need more study. Pilot questions are marked with an asterisk (*).

Domain	Questions
A. Data Collection and Graphing	2*, 8, 9, 11, 21, 22, 24, 27*, 32, 38, 45, 67, 69, 72, 75
B. Behavior Assessment	5, 7, 15, 20*, 25, 58, 65, 80, 81
C. Behavior Acquisition	10, 12, 14, 19*, 23, 28, 29, 35, 36, 37, 40, 43, 50*, 52, 53, 61, 63, 64, 71, 79, 82

D. Behavior Reduction	1, 3, 6, 16, 34, 41, 42, 46, 51*, 54, 56, 59*, 60, 62, 74, 83
E. Documentation and Reporting	17, 18, 31, 39, 44*, 48, 49, 57, 73, 78, 85
F. Ethics	4, 13, 26, 30*, 33, 47, 55, 66, 68, 70*, 76, 77, 84

Answers and explanations

1. Whenever a client's mother gets on the phone, the client screams, and the mother stops to say "Please be quiet." What function is most likely?

   Correct answer: D. Attention

   Look at when it happens (attention is diverted) and what follows (mom's attention, even as a reprimand). Attention doesn't have to be positive to reinforce behavior.

   Task D.1 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

2. An RBT often skips steps of a written reinforcement procedure. What is the biggest risk of this poor procedural fidelity? PILOT · UNSCORED

   Correct answer: B. The supervisor cannot tell whether the intervention works, because it was not implemented as written

   If the plan isn't implemented as written, the data reflect a different intervention. Your supervisor might drop an effective plan or keep an ineffective one. Treatment integrity is what makes data-based decisions possible.

   Task A.8 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 10: Planning and Evaluating Applied Behavior Analysis Research

3. A client rocks in his chair. The plan reinforces sitting with all four chair legs on the floor. This is an example of:

   Correct answer: A. Differential reinforcement of incompatible behavior (DRI)

   DRI reinforces a behavior that physically can't happen at the same time as the problem behavior. You can't rock and have all four legs on the floor at once.

   Task D.3 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 25: Differential Reinforcement

4. You want to post in an online RBT forum asking for advice about a client, describing his age, school, and specific behaviors, but not his name. What should you do?

   Correct answer: D. Don't post it, and ask your supervisor instead

   Details like age, school, and behaviors can identify a client even without a name. Clinical questions go to your supervisor, not social media or online forums.

   Task F.6 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.09

5. Which of the following is an indirect functional assessment method?

   Correct answer: C. A structured interview or rating scale completed by caregivers

   Indirect methods rely on reports from people who know the client (interviews, questionnaires, rating scales), not on direct observation. ABC data and scatterplots are descriptive (direct observation). A functional analysis is experimental.

   Task B.3 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

6. A client's attention-maintained yelling was extinguished. Weeks later, it suddenly reappears briefly at the start of a session. This is:

Correct answer: B. Spontaneous recovery

Spontaneous recovery is when an extinguished behavior briefly returns after time has passed. Keep extinction in place and it usually fades quickly. Reinforcing it now would restart the problem.

Task D.6 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 24: Extinction

7. Your supervisor gives you a scatterplot to fill in throughout the day for a client's self-injury. What is this tool mainly designed to show?

Correct answer: A. Whether the behavior tends to occur at certain times of day

A scatterplot shows patterns across time periods, such as behavior clustering around transitions or before lunch. Those patterns point your supervisor toward possible triggers, but a scatterplot alone doesn't confirm function.

Task B.3 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

8. Your supervisor changes a client's intervention from baseline to a token system. How should this be shown on the line graph?

Correct answer: B. Draw a phase change line and do not connect data points across it

A vertical phase change line shows when conditions changed. Data paths aren't connected across it, because the two phases reflect different conditions. Keeping baseline on the same graph is what lets your supervisor see whether the intervention made a difference.

Task A.4 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 6: Constructing and Interpreting Graphic Displays of Behavioral Data

9. A client had three tantrums lasting 4, 6, and 8 minutes. What is the mean duration per tantrum?

Correct answer: A. 6 minutes

Mean duration = total duration ÷ number of episodes. (4 + 6 + 8) = 18 minutes ÷ 3 = 6 minutes. 18 minutes is the total duration, a different summary that answers a different question.

Task A.6 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

10. What is a key difference between incidental teaching and discrete-trial teaching?

Correct answer: B. In incidental teaching, the learner's interest or initiation sets up the teaching opportunity

Incidental teaching is learner-initiated. The client shows interest, and you use that moment to teach. DTT is instructor-initiated and more structured. Both can use prompts.

Task C.4 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 30: Generalization and Maintenance of Behavior Change

11. A client's correct responses across 8 sessions are 20%, 30%, 30%, 45%, 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%. How would you describe the data?

Correct answer: B. An increasing trend

The overall direction of the data path is upward, even with one flat spot (30% to 30%). For a skill acquisition target, an increasing trend means the teaching is working.

Task A.7 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 6: Constructing and Interpreting Graphic Displays of Behavioral Data

12. To teach a client to identify the letter "b," you first make it bold and red, then gradually fade it to plain black text. This is an example of:

Correct answer: C. Stimulus fading

Changing a feature of the stimulus (color, boldness) and then fading it is stimulus fading. You're prompting through the materials, not through your own behavior. The goal is responding to the plain letter.

Task C.7 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

13. You realize you entered the wrong data for yesterday's session. Which core principle guides you to report and correct it?

Correct answer: D. Behave with integrity

Integrity means honesty and truthfulness, including owning and correcting your own mistakes. Accurate data protect the client.

Task F.1 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.01

14. During receptive identification trials, you always place the correct card on the left. The client gets 100% correct. What problem might this create?

Correct answer: D. The client may be responding to the position rather than the picture

If the correct answer is always in the same spot, the client may learn "touch left" instead of the target. Rotate positions so the target picture, not the position, controls responding.

Task C.6 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

15. While helping with a standardized skills assessment, you notice the client can almost complete an item if you give a small gesture. What should you do?

Correct answer: C. Follow the assessment's instructions for prompting and scoring, and note the observation for your supervisor

Standardized assessments must be given as written. Otherwise, the results don't reflect the client's true skills. Your observation is valuable, so share it with your supervisor, but don't change the scoring.

Task B.2 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 18: Verbal Behavior

16. Two clients both bang their heads. For one, it is maintained by escape, and for the other by automatic reinforcement. What does this show?

Correct answer: A. The same topography can serve different functions

What behavior looks like (topography) doesn't tell you why it happens (function). That's why interventions are based on function. The same behavior may need different treatments.

Task D.1 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

17. Which should NOT be included in an RBT's session note?

Correct answer: D. The RBT's opinion that the client may have ADHD

Diagnostic opinions are outside an RBT's scope and don't belong in session notes. Notes should include objective facts: session times, targets, data, and incidents.

Task E.4 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.03; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

18. A parent tells you the client's school schedule is changing next week to earlier hours. What should you do?

Correct answer: C. Document the change and inform your supervisor

Schedule changes can affect behavior, fatigue, and session times. Report them so your supervisor can plan and interpret the data accurately.

Task E.3 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

19. A client stays seated for 10 seconds. The goal is 5 minutes. Your supervisor sets criteria of 20 seconds, then 40 seconds, then 1 minute, and so on. This is shaping across which dimension? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: C. Duration

Shaping can target different dimensions of a behavior. Here, sitting stays the same but the length of time increases, so it's shaping duration.

Task C.10 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 22: Shaping

20. In the attention condition of a functional analysis, what typically happens when the client engages in the target behavior? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: A. The therapist delivers brief attention, such as a statement of concern

The attention condition tests whether attention maintains the behavior. The therapist is present but busy, and gives brief attention only after the target behavior. Removing demands is the escape condition, and giving a toy is a tangible condition.

Task B.3 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

21. Which behavior is best suited to a simple frequency (event) count?

Correct answer: A. Throwing objects, where each throw has a clear beginning and end

Event recording works best for discrete behaviors, meaning ones with a clear start and end that take about the same amount of time each time. Staying seated, long crying episodes, and engagement are ongoing behaviors, so duration or interval methods fit them better.

Task A.1 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

22. A good operational definition of a target behavior should include:

Correct answer: A. A clear description of the behavior with examples and non-examples

A strong operational definition lets any trained observer tell what counts and what doesn't. Examples and non-examples draw that line. Diagnosis, guesses about motivation, and opinions don't help anyone measure the behavior consistently.

Task A.5 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 3: Selecting and Defining Target Behaviors

23. What distinguishes shaping from chaining?

Correct answer: C. Shaping reinforces successive approximations of one behavior, while chaining links separate behaviors into a sequence

Here's the distinction: shaping changes one behavior gradually toward a target form (like a word's pronunciation). Chaining combines multiple distinct behaviors into a sequence (like the steps of handwashing).

Task C.10 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 22: Shaping

24. Your supervisor asks for duration data on tantrums. The definition says a tantrum begins with crying plus falling to the floor and ends after 10 seconds without either behavior. When do you stop the timer?

Correct answer: D. When 10 seconds have passed with no crying or falling to the floor, per the definition

Notice that the definition gives you onset and offset criteria. Following them exactly is what makes your duration data reliable and comparable to another observer's. Stopping at the first pause, or when you "feel" it's over, adds your judgment to the data.

Task A.1 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

25. You present one item at a time and record whether the client approaches or engages with it. What kind of preference assessment is this?

Correct answer: B. Single stimulus

Single-stimulus (successive choice) presents one item at a time and records approach or engagement. It's useful for clients who have trouble choosing between items, but it doesn't rank items against each other as clearly as other formats.

Task B.1 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

26. A client's teacher calls and asks you for details from the client's behavior plan. What should you do?

Correct answer: B. Refer the request to your supervisor, who will check whether consent to share exists

Sharing confidential information requires proper consent and supervisor direction. Route the request to your supervisor rather than sharing or lying.

Task F.5 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.10

27. In baseline, a client's aggression averaged about 15 per session. Right after intervention started, it dropped to about 3 per session and stayed there. Which change is most evident?

PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: D. An immediate change in level

Level is where the data sit on the y-axis. An abrupt, lasting drop from around 15 to around 3 when the phase changes is a change in level. It's a strong visual sign that the intervention may be responsible.

Task A.7 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 6: Constructing and Interpreting Graphic Displays of Behavioral Data

28. Why should reinforcement be delivered immediately after the target behavior during acquisition?

Correct answer: B. A delay allows other behaviors to occur and be reinforced instead

The closer the reinforcer follows the response, the stronger the effect. During a delay, the client may do something else (look away, fidget), and that's what gets reinforced. Deliver it within a second or two.

Task C.1 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

29. What is a task analysis?

Correct answer: A. Breaking a complex skill into smaller, teachable steps in order

A task analysis breaks a complex skill, like toothbrushing, into a sequence of discrete steps. It's the foundation for any chaining procedure, since you need the steps before you can teach them.

Task C.5 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 23: Chaining

30. A family you work with speaks mainly Spanish, and you don't. What is the most appropriate action? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: D. Talk with your supervisor about language support, such as an interpreter or translated materials

Cultural responsiveness includes making sure families can take part fully. Work with your supervisor on appropriate language support. Children shouldn't serve as interpreters for clinical information.

Task F.10 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.07

31. The client's occupational therapist suggests using a weighted vest during sessions. What should you do?

Correct answer: B. Relay the suggestion to your supervisor and wait for direction

Suggestions from other providers go through your supervisor, who decides whether and how they fit into the ABA program. Don't add or reject interventions on your own.

Task E.1 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.06; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

32. A client takes a long time to start working after being given a worksheet. The goal is to shorten this delay. Which measure fits the goal?

Correct answer: B. Latency from the worksheet being given to the first pencil stroke

The goal is about the delay before starting, so measure from the stimulus (getting the worksheet) to the start of the response. That's latency. Total work time, output, and gaps between problems each answer a different question.

Task A.1 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

33. Which is an example of an effective supervision practice?

Correct answer: C. The supervisor directly observes you with a client and gives specific feedback

Direct observation with specific feedback is a hallmark of effective supervision. Combined with instructions, modeling, and rehearsal, it builds and maintains your skills.

Task F.4 (Ethics). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 31: Ethical and Professional Responsibilities of Applied Behavior Analysts

34. What is the primary purpose of a crisis or emergency plan?

Correct answer: A. To keep the client and others safe using pre-planned, approved procedures

Crisis procedures are about safety, not teaching or punishment. They spell out what trained staff should do so decisions aren't made on the spot under stress.

Task D.7 (Behavior Reduction). Source: BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

35. During natural environment training, you place a favorite toy in a clear container the client can't open. What is the purpose of this?

Correct answer: B. To create motivation for the client to request help or the toy

Contriving the motivating operation (making something wanted but not reachable) creates a natural teaching opportunity. The client's motivation drives the request, and getting the toy is the natural reinforcer.

Task C.4 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 16: Motivating Operations

36. A client was taught to say "Hello." Without training, he starts saying "Hi" and "Hey" to greet people. This is an example of:

Correct answer: B. Response generalization

Response generalization is untrained forms of behavior that serve the same function as the trained response. Stimulus generalization is the same response occurring under new conditions (new people, places, materials).

Task C.8 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 30: Generalization and Maintenance of Behavior Change

37. A client becomes less interested in the same sticker used as a reinforcer every trial. Which strategy should you discuss with your supervisor?

Correct answer: C. Varying the reinforcers used across trials

Using the same reinforcer over and over can lead to satiation. Varying reinforcers keeps motivation higher. Reinforcer magnitude, quality, and variety all affect how well reinforcement works.

Task C.1 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

38. Which is the most measurable definition of on-task behavior during independent seatwork?

Correct answer: C. Eyes directed at the worksheet or teacher, and writing or manipulating assigned materials

"Attention," "focus," and "interest" are internal states. The correct definition names specific, observable actions, such as where the eyes are directed and what the hands are doing, so that two observers would agree.

Task A.5 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 3: Selecting and Defining Target Behaviors

39. You and another RBT recorded very different data on the same client and skill this week. What should you do?

Correct answer: D. Report the data inconsistency to your supervisor

Big data differences suggest a problem with the definition, the procedure, or implementation. Your supervisor needs to know so it can be fixed. That's exactly what data irregularities means.

Task E.2 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

40. Which schedule of reinforcement typically produces high, steady rates of responding with little pausing?

Correct answer: B. Variable ratio (VR)

On a VR schedule, reinforcement comes after an unpredictable number of responses, so responding stays high and steady. Fixed ratio often shows pauses after reinforcement, and fixed interval produces a "scallop" where responding speeds up near the end of the interval.

Task C.1 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 13: Schedules of Reinforcement

41. A client hits her brother when he takes the tablet, and her parents give the tablet back to stop the hitting. What is the most likely function of hitting?

Correct answer: D. Access to tangibles

The consequence is getting the tablet back. When problem behavior reliably produces an item or activity, access to tangibles is the likely function.

Task D.1 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

42. When may an RBT use a punishment procedure?

Correct answer: A. Only when it is written in the behavior plan and the RBT has been trained and cleared by the supervisor

Restrictive and punishment procedures require a written plan and documented supervisor verification of competence. RBTs never add or improvise punishment.

Task D.5 (Behavior Reduction). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.05

43. You are starting with a new client who avoids you. What is the best first step to establish yourself as a conditioned reinforcer?

Correct answer: A. Pair yourself with preferred items and activities without placing demands

Pairing means associating yourself with good things (play, snacks, fun activities) before asking for much. Over time, your presence and attention become reinforcing. Starting with heavy demands can make you a signal for work instead.

Task C.2 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

44. When should you complete your session note? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: C. As soon as possible after the session, within the timeline set by your agency

Timely notes are more accurate and meet legal, payer, and workplace requirements. Waiting days leads to errors from memory.

Task E.4 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

45. Why is partial-interval recording often used for behaviors targeted for reduction?

Correct answer: C. It tends to overestimate the behavior, so any real decrease is not overstated

Partial-interval scores an interval if the behavior happens at any point, so it tends to overestimate. For behavior you're trying to reduce, that conservative error works in your favor. It does not give an exact count or duration.

Task A.2 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

46. For a client whose problem behavior is maintained by escape, the plan gives a 1-minute break every 5 minutes regardless of behavior. This antecedent strategy is:

Correct answer: A. Noncontingent escape (NCR with breaks)

Time-based breaks deliver the maintaining reinforcer (escape) freely, which reduces the client's motivation to escape through problem behavior. That's NCR applied to an escape function.

Task D.2 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 26: Antecedent Interventions

47. A client's parent sends you a friend request on your personal social media. What should you do?

Correct answer: A. Politely decline and inform your supervisor

Personal social media connections with client families create multiple relationships that can blur boundaries and risk confidentiality. Decline politely and inform your supervisor.

Task F.7 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.10

48. A parent complains to you that another RBT is often late to sessions. What should you do?

Correct answer: A. Tell the parent you will share the concern and bring it to your supervisor

Concerns from the team, including about staff, go to your supervisor through proper channels. Handling it yourself or discussing it publicly isn't professional.

Task E.1 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.06; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

49. Which statement belongs in an objective session note?

Correct answer: C. The client hit the RBT's arm 3 times during the transition from play to work

Objective notes report observable facts: what, how many, and when. Explanations like "because she was tired" or "bad mood" are speculation.

Task E.4 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

50. In a token economy, what is the best way to deliver a token after a correct response? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: D. Immediately, paired with specific praise

Deliver tokens right after the target behavior and pair them with specific praise ("Great job sitting!"). Immediacy strengthens the behavior, and pairing helps praise become a reinforcer too.

Task C.11 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 28: Token Economy, Group Contingencies, and Contingency Contracting

51. A client learned to ask for a break instead of screaming. When staff stop honoring break requests, screaming returns. This is: PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: C. Resurgence

Resurgence is when a previously reinforced behavior returns because a more recently reinforced behavior is put on extinction. It's one reason to keep reinforcing replacement behaviors consistently.

Task D.6 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 24: Extinction

52. In most-to-least prompting, what happens over successive trials?

Correct answer: D. The instructor starts with the most intrusive prompt and fades to less intrusive prompts

Most-to-least starts with maximum support (often full physical) and fades as the client succeeds. It's often chosen for new skills because it reduces errors.

Task C.7 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

53. In forward chaining, how is the chain taught?

Correct answer: B. The first step is taught first, and each later step is added once the earlier steps are mastered

Forward chaining starts at the beginning of the task analysis and adds steps in order. Backward chaining starts at the end, and total task teaches all steps every trial.

Task C.5 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 23: Chaining

54. Why is differential reinforcement usually combined with extinction of the problem behavior?

Correct answer: B. So that only the appropriate behavior produces the reinforcer

If problem behavior still produces the reinforcer, the client has no reason to switch. Pairing differential reinforcement with extinction makes the appropriate behavior the only way to get what the client wants.

Task D.3 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 25: Differential Reinforcement; Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 24: Extinction

55. Your agency asks you to start working with adults with brain injuries. You have only worked with young children with autism. What should you do?

Correct answer: A. Tell your supervisor and get training before providing services to this population

RBTs don't provide services to unfamiliar populations or use unfamiliar interventions without proper training. Raise it with your supervisor and get trained first.

Task F.2 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.04

56. During extinction for attention-maintained whining, staff occasionally give in and respond. What is the likely result?

Correct answer: A. Whining becomes more persistent and harder to extinguish

Occasional reinforcement puts the behavior on an intermittent schedule, which makes it more resistant to extinction. Consistency across all staff is critical.

Task D.4 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 24: Extinction

57. At the start of a session, the client seems lethargic and the parent says she had a fever last night. What is the best action?

Correct answer: D. Follow agency illness policy, notify your supervisor, and document it

Illness affects performance and can explain unusual data. Follow the agency's policy (some require canceling), notify your supervisor, and document it.

Task E.3 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

58. After a paired stimulus assessment, a client chose bubbles 90% of the time. What should you understand about this result?

Correct answer: D. Bubbles are highly preferred, but whether they function as a reinforcer depends on whether they increase behavior

Preference assessments identify likely reinforcers. An item is only a reinforcer if it increases the behavior it follows. Preferences also change, so high preference today isn't a lifetime guarantee.

Task B.1 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

59. During a session, your client has a seizure and is unresponsive. What should you do?

PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: C. Follow the agency's medical emergency procedures, including calling emergency services if required

Medical emergencies follow emergency protocols, such as calling 911 when indicated. After safety is secured, notify your supervisor and document.

Task D.7 (Behavior Reduction). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.07; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

60. A client's screaming is maintained by escape. The plan teaches him to say "Break please" and gives a brief break when he asks. This is:

Correct answer: B. Functional communication training (FCT)

FCT teaches a communication response that produces the same reinforcer as the problem behavior. Here, asking for a break replaces screaming for escape.

Task D.3 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 25: Differential Reinforcement

61. A client has mastered labeling 20 animals. How should these targets usually be handled going forward?

Correct answer: C. Move them to maintenance, practicing them occasionally mixed with acquisition targets

Mastered skills move to maintenance: occasional practice with thinner reinforcement, often mixed in with new targets. This keeps them strong without taking up acquisition time.

Task C.9 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 30: Generalization and Maintenance of Behavior Change

62. A client screams during worksheets. The plan starts with only 1 problem per worksheet and gradually increases the number as screaming stays low. This is:

Correct answer: A. Demand fading

Demand fading reduces task demands at first, then gradually brings them back as the client succeeds. It lowers the motivation to escape while building tolerance.

Task D.2 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 26: Antecedent Interventions

63. In discrete-trial teaching, what is the purpose of the intertrial interval?

Correct answer: D. A brief pause that separates trials so each one has a clear beginning and end

The intertrial interval is the short pause after the consequence and before the next SD. It clearly separates trials and gives you time to record data. Keep it brief so the pace stays engaging.

Task C.3 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

64. A client waits for your gesture before responding even on well-learned targets. What problem is this, and what does it suggest?

Correct answer: C. Prompt dependency, which suggests prompts need to be faded more systematically

When a client relies on prompts that should be gone, that's prompt dependency. Systematic fading plans (time delay, least-to-most) and differential reinforcement for independent responses help. Let your supervisor know.

Task C.7 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

65. Your supervisor asks you to observe a client during recess and record how often he initiates play with peers. This contributes to which type of assessment?

Correct answer: C. A social skills assessment

Observing peer initiations shows social skill strengths and deficits in a natural setting. That fits a social skills assessment. A functional analysis is about why problem behavior occurs.

Task B.2 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 3: Selecting and Defining Target Behaviors

66. A teacher disagrees with how you handle a client's behavior in class. What shows good interpersonal skills?

Correct answer: A. Listen actively, acknowledge her concerns, and share them with your supervisor

Collaboration means listening, respecting others' views, and bringing concerns to the right person. You represent both yourself and ABA in every professional interaction.

Task F.9 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.03

67. Your supervisor wants to increase a client's sustained on-task behavior and asks for a measure that will not overestimate it. Which method is the best fit?

Correct answer: C. Whole-interval recording

Whole-interval requires the behavior to occur for the entire interval, so it tends to underestimate. For a behavior you want to increase, that's the safer error, since you won't mistakenly conclude the client is on-task more than they are.

Task A.2 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

68. At the end of a session, a client gives you a drawing she made for you. Your employer has no gift policy. What should you do?

Correct answer: A. Accept it graciously, since it has little monetary value and expresses gratitude

The code allows gifts worth $10 or less that express gratitude without financial benefit. A child's drawing fits that. Refusing could be unnecessarily hurtful.

Task F.8 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.11

69. You use 30-second momentary time sampling for a client's hand-flapping. In one interval, the client flaps at second 12 and stops at second 20. At second 30, she is not flapping. How do you score this interval?

Correct answer: C. Not scored as an occurrence

In momentary time sampling, only the moment the interval ends counts. She wasn't flapping at second 30, so the interval isn't scored, even though flapping happened earlier. That's the trade-off of MTS: it's efficient but can miss behavior.

Task A.2 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

70. According to the RBT Ethics Code, how long must an RBT wait after a professional relationship with a client's parent ends before entering a romantic relationship with that parent?

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Correct answer: A. At least two years

The code requires a minimum of two years after the professional relationship ends before a romantic or sexual relationship with a former client or stakeholder. During services, it's prohibited.

Task F.7 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.12

71. During DTT, you give the instruction "Touch cup," but the client doesn't respond. Which action best follows good DTT practice?

Correct answer: C. Follow the program's prompting procedure instead of repeating the instruction over and over

Repeating the SD many times teaches the client to wait for repetitions, and changing the wording makes the SD inconsistent. Present the SD clearly once, then follow the program's prompting and error correction steps.

Task C.3 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

72. Which target behavior could NOT be measured through permanent product recording?

Correct answer: A. Greeting a peer by saying "Hi"

Permanent product recording needs a lasting result you can check after the behavior happens. Dishes, traced letters, and a block tower all remain. A spoken greeting leaves no product unless it's recorded, so you'd measure it while it happens.

Task A.3 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

73. You will be starting a new crisis procedure next week and feel unsure about it. What should you do?

Correct answer: B. Ask your supervisor for training and practice before you need to use it

Seek training before you need a skill, especially a safety procedure. Supervisors expect you to identify your training needs and ask for help early.

Task E.2 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.06; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

74. A client writes on the wall and is required to clean the entire wall. Writing on walls decreases. This is an example of:

Correct answer: D. Positive punishment

Adding an effortful task after the behavior, which then decreases, is positive punishment. Restoring the environment to a better-than-before state is restitutional overcorrection. Use only if written in the plan and after training.

Task D.5 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 14: Positive Punishment

75. Using partial-interval recording, the behavior was scored in 12 of 40 intervals. What should you report?

Correct answer: B. The behavior occurred in 30% of intervals

Interval data are summarized as the percentage of intervals scored: 12 ÷ 40 = 30%. Here's the distinction that trips people up: this doesn't mean the behavior occurred 12 times or for 30% of the session. It means it occurred in 30% of the intervals.

Task A.6 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

76. Your only BACB-qualified supervisor leaves the agency, and no new supervisor has been assigned. What should you do?

Correct answer: D. Stop providing RBT services until a qualified supervisor is in place

RBTs may only practice under ongoing supervision from a qualified supervisor. Without one, you can't provide RBT services.

Task F.3 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.03

77. Which public statement by an RBT is appropriate?

Correct answer: D. "I work under BCBA supervision to implement treatment plans."

Public statements must accurately represent your credentials, role, and service outcomes. Promising a cure or claiming credentials you don't have is misrepresentation.

Task F.6 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.05

78. A client's father tells you that his son's tantrums at home have gotten much worse this week. What should you do?

Correct answer: B. Share the information with your supervisor promptly

Caregiver reports are important clinical information. Pass them to your supervisor promptly so she can decide what to do. Reassuring him or making a plan yourself goes beyond your role.

Task E.1 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.06; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

79. Which best describes a discriminative stimulus (SD)?

Correct answer: D. A stimulus that signals reinforcement is available for a specific response

An SD is present before the behavior and signals that responding will be reinforced. A stimulus signaling reinforcement is not available is an S-delta. Stimuli delivered after a response are consequences.

Task C.6 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

80. In a multiple stimulus with replacement (MSW) assessment, what happens after the client selects an item?

Correct answer: D. The selected item stays in the array and the other items are replaced

In MSW, the chosen item stays available while the unchosen items are swapped for new ones. Contrast that with MSWO, where the chosen item is removed. The "W" or "WO" tells you what happens to the chosen item.

Task B.1 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

81. Right before a session, the client just finished a large bag of chips at lunch. Why might chips not work as a reinforcer this session?

Correct answer: B. Recent access has reduced their value (satiation)

Satiation is a motivating operation that temporarily lowers the value of a reinforcer. That's why quick preference checks before or during sessions are useful, since what worked yesterday may not work right after lunch.

Task B.1 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 16: Motivating Operations

82. A client used to work hard for tokens, but lately tokens aren't increasing behavior. Staff have stopped allowing exchanges for backup reinforcers. What is the most likely reason?

Correct answer: D. The tokens lost value because they were no longer paired with backup reinforcers

Conditioned reinforcers keep their power only if they're still paired with other reinforcers. If tokens can't be exchanged, they stop meaning anything. Keep exchanges consistent with the plan.

Task C.2 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 28: Token Economy, Group Contingencies, and Contingency Contracting

83. A client's hand-mouthing is maintained by automatic reinforcement (the sensation). The plan has the client wear soft gloves during certain activities. This is an example of:

Correct answer: A. Sensory extinction

Sensory extinction masks or removes the sensory consequence of the behavior. The gloves change the sensation, so the behavior no longer produces its automatic reinforcer.

Task D.4 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 24: Extinction

84. You finish a home session and need to carry paper data sheets back to the clinic. What is the best practice?

Correct answer: C. Keep them secured and out of sight, and bring them directly to the clinic

Confidential client information must be stored and transported securely. Leaving data sheets exposed or sending photos by personal text puts the client's privacy at risk.

Task F.5 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.08

85. You have several questions for your supervisor. Which should you prioritize?

Correct answer: B. A concern about the client's safety

Safety concerns come first. Prioritizing clinical direction means knowing what's urgent (safety, major behavior changes) versus what can wait for the next meeting.

Task E.2 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.07; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)